Event Storming — Facilitator Cheat Sheet

Keep beside you during the session. Times assume a 2.5–3 h workshop with 6–12 participants.

1. Session flow

Phase	Time	You do	You say
Kick off	10 min	State goal and scope; demo the legend with one example chain.	"We map what *happens* in the business — past tense."
Chaotic exploration	25 min	Everyone writes orange events silently, sticks them anywhere. Refill note pads.	"No talking yet. One event per note."
Enforce timeline	15 min	Sort left→right, dedupe, invite corrections.	"What happens just before this?"
Hotspots	10 min	Red notes on anything disputed or unclear. Do not debate.	"Mark it, don't solve it."
Commands & actors	20 min	Blue command before each event; note who/what triggers it.	"What makes this happen?"
Aggregates & policies	15 min	Yellow aggregates handling commands; purple policies for automatic rules; pink external systems.	"Is this automatic, or does someone decide?"
Walk the narrative	10 min	Read the board forward, then backward; fix gaps live.	"Tell me the story of an order."
Wrap up	10 min	Draw boundaries, photograph, assign hotspot owners.	"Where does one world end and another begin?"

2. Legend quick reference

Event	past-tense verb
Command	imperative verb
Aggregate	noun (handles commands)
Policy	"when X, then Y"
Read model	data needed to decide
External system	noun (third party)
Hotspot	problem / open question

3. Prompts that unstick the room

> *"What happens right before / after that?"*

> *"What would make this step fail?"*

> *"Who notices that this happened?"*

> *"Is that always true? What about refunds / edge cases?"*

> *"If we removed this event, who would complain?"*

4. Common pitfalls

> **Solutioning too early** — park design ideas on hotspots; events first.

> **One loud voice** — silent writing phases; invite the quiet experts directly.

> **Nouns, not events** — "Order" is a thing; "Order Placed" is an event.

> **Scope creep** — restate the scope; park out-of-scope events on a side strip.

> **Airplane view forever** — after the timeline works, go one level deeper on one flow.

5. Wrap-up checklist

- Boundaries between subdomains drawn and named
- Every hotspot has an owner and a follow-up date
- Board photographed (whole wall + close-ups per section)
- Next step agreed: refine model, write stories, or design